

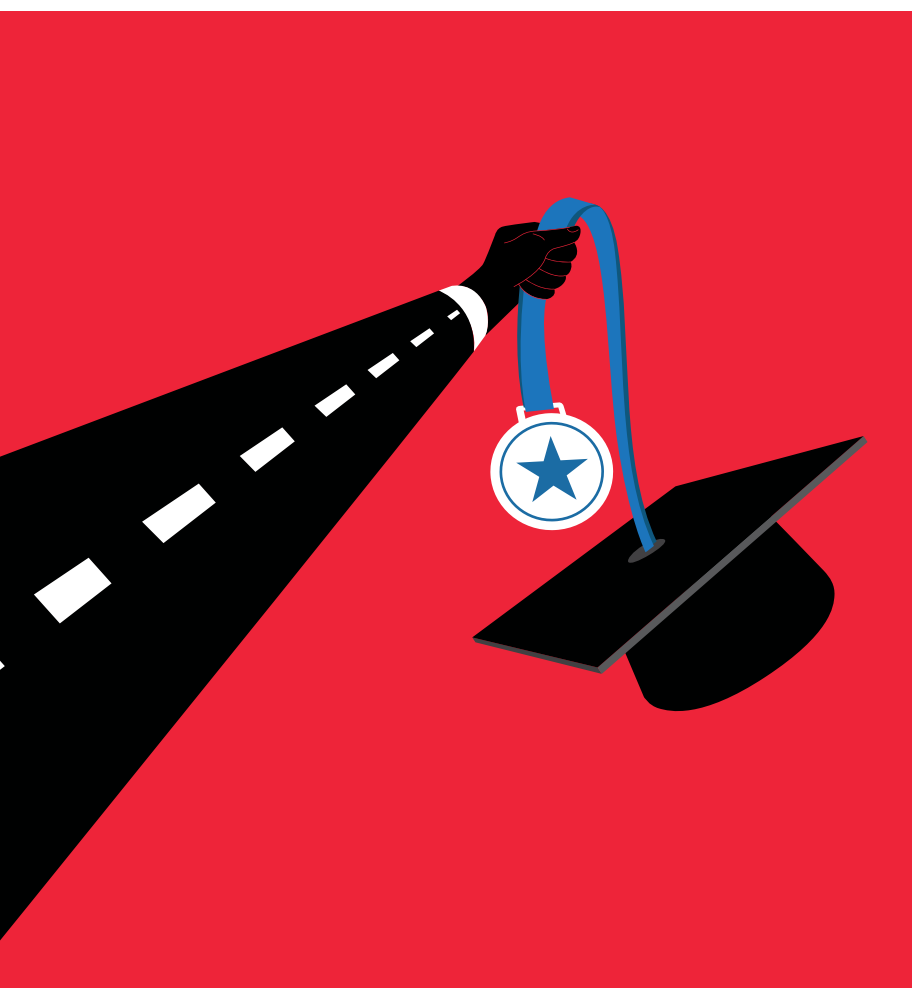


ILLUSTRATION BY RAJ VERMA

comes to dimensions such as research/academic publications, international student/faculty diversity, international mobility (for e.g. alumni working abroad), and female representation on the board/faculty. Indian schools may have a high overall ranking; however, their research rank is lower (as low as between 90-100). Similarly, international mobility ranks are between 80-100 for these schools.

If we compare Indian schools vis-à-vis global benchmarks within the FT Global MBA ranking, it is ob-

served that Indian schools lead on career progress, alumni network, employment at 3 months, percentage salary increase, and proportion of female students.

However, they are playing catch up on other parameters. Doing well on these is a more resource-intensive long-term exercise but will enable schools to move up the ranking ladder.

Road Map For The Future

So, what should Indian B-schools do if they want to see themselves on the

international stage and be a part of global rankings? Successful career and alumni outcomes are major driving forces, and some schools are most definitely leading the charge here.

There are those who may not yet figure in such rankings but have contributed significantly to student career aspirations and offer excellent value for money in the process. That said, Indian schools must build global employability for their graduates, cross border career services and a broader alumni footprint abroad is valued tremendously.

One critical issue to focus on is research and thought leadership. Global rankings place great emphasis on publications in globally recognised journals and how a school shapes management thinking.

B-schools in India have come a long way on the research front but more needs to be done. Investing in cutting-edge research areas as well as faculty is key.

The importance of contributing to international case repositories such as Harvard and Ivey should not be underestimated.

Internationalisation and diversity (beyond students) are two elephants in the room and require introspection and support from those at the top within Indian schools.

They must do more to attract faculty as well as student talent from across the world and facilitate global exchange programmes for their own students.

To conclude, breaking into global rankings requires sustained effort, a deeper understanding of the parameters used, capitalising on areas of strength, and creating a road map for continuous improvement. It also requires grit, determination and a few bold decisions along the way. **BT**

Views are personal